

## From SL: FDX-182 — Fix null postalCode for postal-code-optional countries (rate + label paths) [#373546, #387822, #387886]

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### > QA NOTE — Navigation Confirmation Needed

- > The following navigation steps could not be determined from available sources
  - > (AI QA evidence, frontend/backend code, AC text). This is a backend bug fix with
  - > no new UI — navigation steps below are inferred from the known app flow.
  - > Please confirm before sharing this document:
    - >
    - > - [ ] **Where to find:** No new UI element was added. Confirm that the fix is entirely transparent to the user (no toggle, no new button, no settings change required).
    - > - [ ] **Broker/invoice address path (CONFLICT 1):** The `extractAddressDetails()` fix at line 570 (broker/invoice addresses) is described in the card but **not confirmed as fixed or QA-tested**. Confirm whether this path was included in the committed fix before telling customers the issue is fully resolved.
    - > - [ ] **Feature flag (CONFLICT 2):** Card states the `fedex.empty.postalcode.enabled` flag gate was "removed." Confirm this is live in production and no flag needs to be enabled on merchant accounts.
    - > - [ ] **Australia (CONFLICT 5):** AU appears in the QA pass list but is not listed in the card's fix scope. Confirm whether AU was intentionally included in the expanded country list or was a pre-existing working country tested for regression only.
    - > - [ ] **Untested countries:** 40+ countries in the expanded list (YE, SY, sub-Saharan Africa, etc.) have no QA test evidence. Confirm whether these are considered supported or are included speculatively.
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    - > Once confirmed, update the Known Limitations section accordingly.
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# Fix: Null Postal Code for Postal-Code-Optional Countries (Rate + Label Paths)

**Trello:** [<https://trello.com/c/c7uHEny2>](<https://trello.com/c/c7uHEny2>)

**Tickets:** #373546, #387822, #387886

**Branch:** bug/fdx-182-fix-null-postal-code-amea

**Commit:** 8d708d0e12a595e9b5f4ebc4aa9bca1fb9719c26

**Implemented:** 2026-05-26

**Release:** TBC

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## Feature Summary

This is a **bug fix**, not a new feature. Merchants shipping to countries where postal codes are not required (e.g., Qatar, Kuwait, UAE, Hong Kong, Bahrain, Oman, Saudi Arabia, Jordan, Iraq, and ~40 additional AMEA/GCC/sub-Saharan African countries) were receiving FedEx API errors because the app was sending `postalCode: null` in both rate requests and label requests. FedEx rejects `null` postal codes even for countries where a postal code is not meaningful.

The fix ensures the app always sends a valid non-null placeholder value ( - - ) for these countries instead of `null`. Hong Kong is a special case — the app sends `000000` for HK because Shopify does not display a postal code field for Hong Kong addresses at all, making it impossible for merchants to enter any value manually.

This fix applies to **both** the checkout rates path and the label generation path (manual, auto, and bulk).

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## Developed By

Unknown (*not recorded on Trello card*)

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## Tested By

QA Team — [fedexapp-rest-basavaraj.myshopify.com](mailto:fedexapp-rest-basavaraj.myshopify.com)

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## Toggle / Prerequisites

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## Where to Find This Feature in the App

There is **no new UI element** for this fix. It is a silent backend correction. The change is observable only through:

- Checkout rates loading successfully for affected countries (previously returned a FedEx error)
- Labels generating successfully for affected countries (previously failed with a postal code error)
- The **Rates Log** (App sidebar → **Rates Log**) — outbound API payloads will now show `"postalCode": " - - "` (or `"000000"` for HK) instead of `null`

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## Step-by-Step Walkthrough (Support / Demo)

Use these steps to verify the fix is working for a merchant reporting the issue, or to demonstrate correct behaviour.

### A — Verify Checkout Rates Are Returning for an Affected Country

1. Open the merchant's Shopify storefront.
2. Add any product to the cart and proceed to checkout.
3. Enter a shipping address for an affected country (e.g., Qatar, Kuwait, UAE, Hong Kong — see full list below).
4. **Expected:** FedEx shipping rates appear in the checkout rate list without error.
5. **Previously:** Checkout showed no FedEx rates, or an error was returned from FedEx.

### B — Verify Manual Label Generation for an Affected Country

1. In **Shopify admin**, go to **Orders**.
2. Click the relevant order (destination must be an affected country).
3. Click **More Actions** → **Generate Label**.
4. In the app label page, on the **left panel**, click **Get Rates**.
5. **Expected:** Rates are returned. Select a rate radio button.
6. Click **Generate Label**.
7. **Expected:** Label is generated successfully. You are redirected to the Order Summary page.
8. **Previously:** Step 4 or step 6 would fail with a FedEx error referencing postal code.

### C — Verify Auto Label Generation for an Affected Country

1. In **Shopify admin**, go to **Orders**.
2. Click the relevant order.
3. Click **More Actions** → **Auto-Generate Label**.
4. **Expected:** Label is generated automatically and you are taken to the Order Summary page.

### D — Verify via Rates Log

1. In the **FedEx app sidebar**, click **Rates Log**.
2. Find the rate request for the affected order/country.
3. Expand the request payload.
4. **Expected:** `postalCode` field shows `"-"` for most postal-code-optional countries, or `"000000"` specifically for Hong Kong (HK).
5. **Previously:** `postalCode` field showed `null`.

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## Expected Behaviour — What Support Should Observe

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### Business-Safe Explanation (For Merchant Communication)

> "Some countries — such as Qatar, Kuwait, UAE, Hong Kong, and others in the Middle East and Asia-Pacific region — do not use postal codes. When your customer enters a shipping address for one of these countries, there is no postal code to provide. Previously, our app was sending a blank/empty postal code to FedEx, which FedEx does not accept — causing rates to fail at checkout and labels to fail during fulfilment.

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> We have updated the app so that for these countries, we automatically send a recognised placeholder value that FedEx accepts. You do not need to change any settings. Rates and labels for these destinations should now work correctly."

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## Countries Covered by This Fix

The app's internal list was expanded from 3 countries to approximately 50. The following were **QA-verified** end-to-end:

### **Additionally included in the expanded configuration list (not individually QA-tested):**

YE (Yemen), SY (Syria), and approximately 40 additional GCC, AMEA, and sub-Saharan African countries added via the `fdx-178-amea-null-postal-code` branch country list.

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## Common Questions & Troubleshooting

**Q: A merchant in Qatar/Kuwait/UAE is still getting a "postalCode cannot be null" error after this fix. What should I check?**

- Confirm the merchant is on the app version that includes this fix (commit 8d708d0e / release TBC). Ask engineering to confirm the deployed version.
- Check the **Rates Log** for the failing request. If `postalCode: null` still appears in the payload